

DESIG 1H26 Retrospective

David Shamlin, July 2026

Note: The letters in brackets (i.e., [K], [P], and [S]) indicate who contributed the item during the retrospective discussion.

1. I'm confused about Time Machine versus hard drive plugged in [K]
2. Suggestions related to assessing skill level
 1. Always discuss novice-level skills [S]
 2. Provide a way to (self?) assess individual skill levels [S]
 3. Send a survey in advance of a session [P]
 4. List in handouts what the basic skills are [P]
3. My skill level with Google is novice/competent. It is pretty apparent David strongly prefers Safari over Chrome. Should I develop Safari skills and stop using Chrome? Similar question related to using Gmail vs Apple Mail. (i.e., just tell us if we should move from Google tech to Apple tech) [S]
4. What do home WiFi routers do? [S & P]

[S] recently working with ISP (AT&T); what's is the difference between a WiFi router vs voice-over-internet (VoIP) + WiFi router
5. How do I migrate from an old device to a new device? [S]

Recently got an M1 Air to replace existing Intel Air. Started using the new M1 Air before going through a migration process. Then had to hire/pay a consultant to perform migration manually.
6. I don't understand mice. With my old computer I needed a hub (i.e., adapter/dongle) to connect my mouse but I don't need a hub with my new computer. Why? [S]
7. If two things are plugged into an adapter/dongle/hub, how does the computer know which thing on the adapter/dongle/hub the computer is talking to? [S]
8. Doe the word "hub" have multiple meanings? [P]
9. A physical therapist spoke with [S] regarding "ergonomics" when using digital devices. How do I develop/maintain a "good" ergonomic practice when using my devices? [S]
10. What is "coding" [P] and why are there different programming languages [S]?
11. Suggestion: add a section to the syllabus/schedule on messaging clients.
12. How do I create a link in a doc or email? [P]
13. Related to hardware, what does "battery" mean? I don't understand the battery. [S]

14. Some high value things folks have gotten out of previous sessions:

1. Understanding the Menu Bar better [K]
2. How to organize and find email [P]
3. Understanding the UI difference between laptops/phones/tablets [S]